

COVER LETTER

Aadarsha Gopala Reddy
St. Louis, MO 63112
(740) 802-1776
adurs2002@gmail.com

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Hiring Manager
Vibe Coding Mentor Program
SureStart
New York, NY

Subject: Application for Vibe Coding Mentor - SureStart

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to apply for the Vibe Coding Mentor position at SureStart. I earned my M.S. in Computer Science from Washington University in St. Louis, with graduate work centered on machine learning and AI. My background includes teaching computer science to high school students, tutoring undergraduates across multiple courses, and mentoring first-generation college students—experience that aligns directly with SureStart’s mission of expanding access to AI education. Having participated in the MITxSureStart FutureMakers Create-a-Thon in 2022, I would value the opportunity to contribute to SureStart’s programs from the mentorship side.

As a Graduate Teaching Assistant for a data engineering course at WashU, I guided students through building data pipelines with Python, SQL, Snowflake, and Spark, conducted technical oral exams, and mentored capstone project teams. I have built full-stack web applications using Vue.js, Node.js, React, and MongoDB through rapid prototyping coursework, and integrated AI APIs including OpenAI and Google Gemini into interactive projects. My AI engineering internship involved building a recommendation system with TensorFlow and Keras, working through the complete ML lifecycle from data generation to model training.

Earlier, as a Computer Science Lab Assistant at Ohio Wesleyan University, I tutored students for over six hours each week across introductory to advanced coursework, helping them debug code and work through challenging concepts. I also delivered an introductory AI workshop for high school students at WashU, introducing core ideas in machine learning. My work as a Graduate Assistant at the Taylor Family Center for Student Success deepened my commitment to supporting students from underserved backgrounds—I led initiatives for first-generation, limited-income students and tracked program impact to improve engagement.

What draws me to this role is SureStart’s emphasis on Responsible AI and opportunity equity—values I share. The Vibe Coding program’s approach of rapid iteration, AI-assisted development, and problem solving through the UN SDGs framework mirrors the rapid prototyping ethos I developed in my coursework. I know firsthand from my FutureMakers experience how impactful these programs are, and I would be glad to support the next cohort of students in building deployed applications that address meaningful social challenges.

Thank you for considering my application. I would welcome the chance to discuss how my teaching experience, AI background, and familiarity with SureStart’s programs could contribute to the Vibe Coding program. I look forward to the possibility of supporting high school students as they develop their skills and build projects with real-world impact.

Sincerely,

Aadarsha Gopala Reddy